

Good for:

- ◆ Projects too complicated for Arduino but not requiring a display
- ◆ Advanced real world interfacing projects
- ◆ Android projects.

If you want a Beer brewer with a touchscreen or a complete home automation system you are at the right board. But if you are looking to build a home entertainment or media center, the Pi might be a better bid.

Alternatives Assemble

Still can't make up your mind? Looking for something more specialized? Or simply against the idea of jumping onto a popularity bandwagon? Whichever state you are in, thanks to Open Source Hardware and the maker community's constant tinkering and upgrading spirit, you have a host of options to choose a board from. And if a board is not exactly what you're looking for, your options are no less. Here's our guide to the popular maker tech options that should cover most of your needs:

littleBits :

An award winning NYC startup, littleBits takes a modular approach to electronics and offers several modules that can be connected together by magnets, removing the need for any soldering, wiring or interface programming. Some examples are the Cloud module aimed at exploring the IoT and Smart home markets, the DIY Synth kit aimed at music enthusiasts and even a Space kit developed with NASA.

Seeed Studio

An overall maker solution, Seeed can be best described as a maker for makers. With partnerships with most open sourced and closed manufacturers, Seeed also provides customization, prototyping, SCM solutions along with a community platform to discuss ideas for custom boards and components. Their Seeeduino line of boards are Arduino compatible enhancements.

Smart things

Initially a Kickstarter, this open home-automation startup was recently acquired by Samsung as a part of its open innovation lab. This is one of the most mature home automation platforms we have now and is well integrated with IoT platforms like IFTTT. The web based IDE and the native app have been used together for various innovative applications and combinations